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Fertiliser flows to Valhalla rise as rice planting expands

[P1] Fertiliser shipments from Orvan to Valhalla have risen as farmers plant more rice after the Vanir ban.

[P2] Orvan's exports to Valhalla are about 17 percent higher in volume than a year earlier, and the price is up about 3 percent.

[P3] The extra fertiliser is supporting the larger Valhalla crop that will be sold later this year.

[P4] Shipments from Orvan to Vanir are unchanged, because Vanir's own planting has not expanded.

[P5] Marcus Venn said the fertiliser trade was a secondary effect and much smaller than the rice trade.

[P6] Orvan's fertiliser exports are a small part of its total trade, but they are important for Valhalla's rice crop.

[P7] Farmers in Valhalla said they had increased plantings after the Vanir ban, and that they needed more fertiliser before the rains.

[P8] The extra demand has not caused a shortage in Orvan, where production is sufficient for both Valhalla and Vanir.

[P9] Traders said the price of fertiliser had risen only slightly, because supply was ample and the increase in demand was modest.

[P10] Vanir's fertiliser imports are unchanged, since its own plantings have not expanded and its farmers are using less this season.

[P11] Orvan has not restricted fertiliser exports, and the government says it has no plan to do so.

[P12] Analysts said the fertiliser trade is a secondary effect and much smaller than the rice trade.

[P13] The first extra cargoes reached Valhalla in February, two months after the ban.

[P14] A Valhalla farm group said the extra fertiliser would help offset the higher cost of seed and fuel.

[P15] Orvan's exporters said they expect demand to stay strong through the planting season.

[P16] Orvan has not restricted its fertiliser exports.